

HOUSE RESOLUTION 103

By Hemmer

A RESOLUTION to recognize Nancy Anness on the occasion of her retirement.

WHEREAS, it is appropriate that the members of this legislative body should honor those citizens who, through their extraordinary efforts and steadfast commitment to service, have distinguished themselves in their professions; and

WHEREAS, one such estimable individual is Nancy Anness, who is taking a well-earned retirement on April 30, 2025, following an exceptional thirty-year career with Ascension Saint Thomas, where she has served with dedication, leadership, and a passion for improving healthcare access and outcomes for all; and

WHEREAS, Ms. Anness began her journey with Ascension Saint Thomas in 1995, after being recruited from Vanderbilt University as a family nurse practitioner and manager and charged with the vital mission of launching clinics to serve the poor and vulnerable by the Daughters of Charity; and

WHEREAS, in pursuit of that mission, Nancy Anness was instrumental in founding the Saint Thomas Family Health Center West, the first comprehensive Saint Thomas Mobile Health Clinic in Middle Tennessee; the Saint Thomas Preston Taylor Clinic; and the Saint Thomas Holy Family Health Center; and

WHEREAS, in addition to her administrative leadership, Ms. Anness continued her direct clinical practice, eventually becoming the executive director of the health centers while continuing to provide care throughout the week; even today, she devotes one day each week to offering charity care for those most in need; and

WHEREAS, Nancy Anness was promoted in 2008 to Vice President of Advocacy and Healthcare Access, a role that later evolved into the Chief Advocacy Officer position she has since held with distinction; and

WHEREAS, she has been a strong leader in government relations at the federal, state, and local levels for many years, driving important initiatives in public policy to ensure access to high-quality health care and the sustainability of Catholic health care for all; and

WHEREAS, Ms. Anness also spearheaded the creation and growth of the Medical Mission at Home initiative, and she continues to make significant contributions to the broader healthcare community; and

WHEREAS, a trusted and respected professional, Nancy Anness has served with distinction on numerous boards, including Diocese Mary Queen of Angels, Tennessee Board of Nursing, Tennessee Hospital Association Government Affairs Council, AccessTN, and the Safety Net Consortium of Middle Tennessee; and

WHEREAS, throughout her estimable career, Ms. Anness has demonstrated the utmost professionalism, ability, and integrity, winning the sincere respect and admiration of her colleagues and the citizens of the State of Tennessee; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, that we honor and commend Nancy Anness for her thirty years of exemplary service to Ascension Saint Thomas and the people of Tennessee, congratulate her on the occasion of her retirement, and extend to her our best wishes for every continued success and happiness in the years to come.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy.